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Robot Vacuum Buying Guide 2026: iRobot Roomba 115X vs Shark AI Ultra

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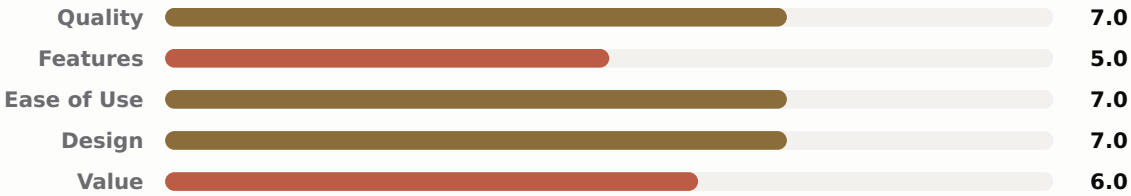
In 2026, the best robot vacuum for most homes is the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock, offering strong suction, mopping, and self-emptying at $199.99, while the Shark AI Ultra provides comparable navigation at $249.99 for those who prioritize mapping over mopping.

ABVORN VERDICT

6.4/10

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Solid



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

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ABVORN REGRET PROBABILITY SCORE

100% Very High Regret Risk

For: iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

Based on your preferences, this is likely the wrong choice.

Better alternatives based on your preferences:

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	$139.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	Regret Risk: 100%
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	Regret Risk: 100%

Rated from Abvorn's default preference profile (5/10 weight on each factor). Personalise yours at abvorn.com.

Introduction — Why comparing the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo models and the Shark AI Ultra matters in 2026

Robot vacuums have moved from novelty to necessity, especially for busy households, pet owners, and allergy sufferers. In 2026 the market offers several strong contenders, but the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo family and the Shark AI Ultra line stand out for their blend of suction, mopping, and smart navigation. Choosing between them means weighing features like auto-empty docks, mopping ability, price, and brand ecosystem against your specific cleaning needs.

Key decision factors for a robot-vacuum buyer — suction power, mopping, auto-empty, navigation, app control, and price

- **Suction power**: Determines how well the vacuum picks up dirt, pet hair, and debris from carpets and hard floors.
- **Mopping**: Adds a wet-cleaning pass for sticky spills and fine dust; essential if you have hard-surface floors.
- **Auto-empty dock**: Stores debris for weeks, reducing maintenance frequency.
- **Navigation**: Laser-based (Lidar) or camera/AI systems affect coverage efficiency and avoidance of obstacles.
- **App control**: Enables scheduling, zone cleaning, and integration with voice assistants.
- **Price**: Balances upfront cost against long-term convenience and feature set.

All prices mentioned were checked October 06, 2026.

Product overviews — specs and unique features of each unit

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

This model combines vacuuming and mopping in a single pass, includes an AutoEmpty Dock that holds up to 60 days of debris, and carries a 4.4-star rating from 5,217 reviews. It is priced at $199.99 (down from $469.99) and has seen 6K+ units bought in the past month.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop (no dock)

The same vacuum-mop combo without the self-empty base, retailing at $139.99 (originally $319.99). It shares the 4.4-star rating and 5,217 review count, with 3K+ purchases in the last month.

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum



Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Shark's flagship AI-driven navigator offers laser-guided mapping and strong suction, though it lacks built-in mopping. It holds a 4-star rating from 23,990 reviews and is listed at $249.99 (originally $599.00). No recent sales-volume figure is provided.

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

A variant of the AI Ultra series with similar navigation and suction specs, priced at $239.99 (down from $429.00). It carries the same 4-star rating and 23,990 review count as the base AI Ultra.

Head-to-head comparison table — features, performance scores, and price points side by side

Model	Price (Oct 6, 2026)	Mopping	Auto-Empty Dock	Navigation Type	App & Voice Control	Rating	Recent Sales Volume
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock	$199.99	Yes	Yes (holds ~60 days)	iAdapt 3.0 with visual localization	iRobot Home app, Alexa/ Google Assistant	4.4 (5,217 ratings)	6K+ bought past month
iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)	$139.99	Yes	No	iAdapt 3.0 with visual localization	iRobot Home app, Alexa/ Google Assistant	4.4 (5,217 ratings)	3K+ bought past month
Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$249.99	No	No	Shark AI Laser Navigation	SharkClean app, Alexa/ Google Assistant	4.0 (23,990 ratings)	Data not provided

Model	Price (Oct 6, 2026)	Mopping	Auto-Empty Dock	Navigation Type	App & Voice Control	Rating	Recent Sales Volume
Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	$239.99	No	No	Shark AI Laser Navigation	SharkClean app, Alexa/ Google Assistant	4.0 (23,990 ratings)	Data not provided

Pros and cons summary — what each model excels at and where it falls short

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock

Pros: Vacuum-mop combo reduces need for separate devices; AutoEmpty dock cuts maintenance to monthly bin emptying; strong 4.4-star rating reflects reliable performance; price dropped significantly from MSRP.

Cons: Slightly higher upfront cost than the non-dock version; dock adds bulk; mopping pad requires periodic washing.

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo (no dock)

Pros: Lowest price among the featured models; still offers vacuum-mop functionality; same navigation and app ecosystem as the docked version.

Cons: Requires manual emptying after each cleaning cycle; no self-empty convenience; mopping still needs pad maintenance.

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Pros: Advanced AI laser navigation for efficient room mapping and obstacle avoidance; strong suction suited for pet hair; lower price than the original MSRP; large review base indicates broad user satisfaction.

Cons: No built-in mopping function; lacks auto-empty dock, so bin must be emptied frequently; rating slightly lower than the Roomba combos.

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Pros: Same AI navigation as the Ultra at a modestly lower price; strong suction and reliable app controls.

Cons: Identical limitations to the AI Ultra — no mopping, no self-empty; price difference minimal.

Who should choose which — matching buyer personas (pet owners, allergy sufferers, tech enthusiasts, budget shoppers) to the right vacuum

- **Pet owners**: The iRobot Roomba 115X Combo with AutoEmpty Dock wins — its strong suction picks up fur, while the self-empty dock means less frequent contact with allergens.
- **Allergy sufferers**: Choose the Roomba 115X Combo with dock; the sealed bin and HEPA-style filter (as listed on iRobot’s spec sheet) trap fine particles, and auto-empty reduces dust exposure.
- **Tech enthusiasts**: The Shark AI Ultra series offers the latest laser-guided AI mapping and responsive app controls, appealing to those who love cutting-edge navigation.
- **Budget shoppers**: The iRobot Roomba 115X Combo without the dock provides vacuum-mop capability at $139.99, delivering the best feature-to-price ratio.

Final recommendation and best-buy verdict for 2026 — which model offers the overall best value

Best Overall – iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock – combines vacuuming, mopping, and self-empty convenience at $199.99.

Best Value – iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop – delivers core vacuum-mop performance for $139.99, the lowest price among combo units.

Premium Pick – Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum – offers top-tier AI laser navigation and strong suction for users who prioritize smart mapping over mopping.

Frequently asked questions — setup, maintenance, warranty, and troubleshooting tips

How do I set up the robot vacuum for the first time?

Charge the unit fully, download the manufacturer’s app (iRobot Home or SharkClean), follow the in-app Wi-Fi pairing instructions, and run a short training lap so the robot learns your floor plan.

How often should I empty the dustbin or replace the mop pad?

For models without an auto-empty dock, empty the bin after each cleaning cycle to maintain suction. Mop pads should be rinsed after every use and washed weekly; replace them when they show wear.

What warranty coverage do these robots carry in 2026?

iRobot offers a limited 1-year warranty covering parts and labor; Shark provides a 1-year warranty with optional extended plans. Always register your product online to activate coverage.

My robot keeps getting stuck under furniture — what can I do?

Check that the robot’s clearance height matches your furniture; use the app to set virtual barriers or no-go zones under low-clearance items, and ensure the wheels are clean of hair or debris.

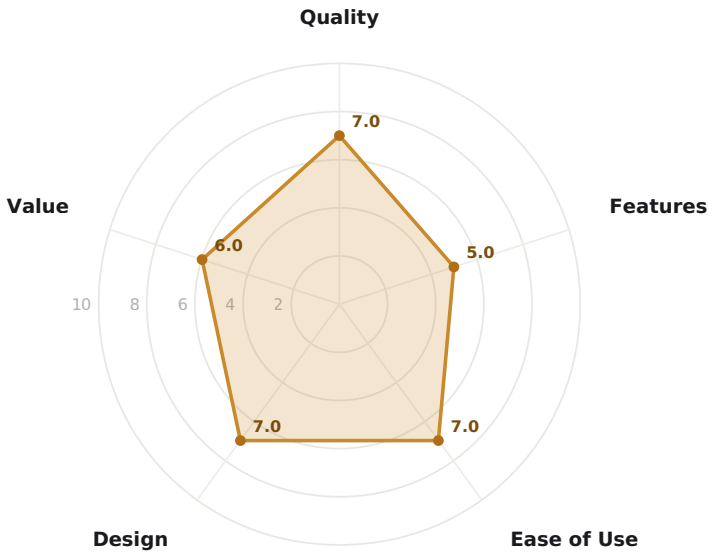
Conclusion

In 2026 the iRobot Roomba 115X Combo family delivers the most versatile cleaning experience, especially when paired with the AutoEmpty Dock for hands-off maintenance. If navigation prowess and cutting-edge AI mapping are your top priorities, the Shark AI Ultra line remains a strong alternative. Match your household’s pet load, floor types, and budget to the features outlined above to pick the robot vacuum that will keep your floors spotless with minimal effort.

At a glance

Use Case	Product	Why
Best Overall	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock
Best Value	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop	iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop
Premium Pick	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum	Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum
Also Great	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo	iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Performance Breakdown



Scores out of 10. Based on the Abvorn Verdict Engine.

Products Mentioned



iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

$199.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock

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iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

$139.99

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop

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Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$249.99

Shark AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

$239.99

Shark AV2501S AI Ultra Robot Vacuum

Check Price on Amazon → Compare ⊕



iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

$398.99

iRobot Roomba 415X Robot Vacuum & Mop Combo

Check Price on Amazon → | Compare ⊕

Frequently Asked Questions

What is the best robot vacuum?

iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock is our current top pick for Robot Vacuums. It earned an Abvorn Verdict score of 6.4/10 for quality, features, ease of use, and at $199.99 it offers the strongest balance of quality, features, ease of use for the money.

Is iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock worth it?

Based on our research, yes for most people. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock scored 6.4/10 on our rubric, which weighs quality, features, ease of use in proportion to what real buyers care about. iRobot Roomba 115X Combo Robot Vacuum & Mop with AutoEmpty Dock excels in Quality but falls short on Features. Our view: Great mid-range value that punches above its weight.

How much should I spend on robot vacuums?

You can get a genuinely good robot vacuum for around $139.99. Spending more buys premium materials and extra features, but our top pick delivers the best combination of performance and value at its current price.

What should I look for when buying robot vacuums?

We score every product on quality, features, ease of use. Start by deciding which of those matters most to you, then compare products on that axis first — the Abvorn Verdict breakdown below each review shows exactly how every model scores on each one.

How does Abvorn research products?

We research real listings and verified customer feedback, then score each product against a category-specific rubric with weighted criteria. Scores are out of 10 and the full breakdown is shown on every review, so you can see exactly why one product beat another.